



Shruti Turner

UNDERSTANDING | MOVEMENT | STRENGTH

Rebuild Your Strength

**How to train intelligently with
chronic illness, pain or injury.**

Hi, I'm Shruti



My Philosophy

Fitness isn't just about how much we can lift in the gym or how fast we can (or can't!) run.

It's about building the capacity to live our lives more fully, feel confident in our body and support our health.

To do more of what matters to us.

Too often, people are given oversimplified explanations for complex experiences:

That pain is only biomechanics, that anxiety is only nervous system dysregulation, or that one style of movement is the answer for everyone.

But our bodies are rarely that simple.

I'm a trauma-informed yoga teacher, Level 4 Strength & Conditioning coach, and I have a PhD focused on rehabilitation with training in neuroscience and biomechanics.

I also live with inflammatory arthritis, asthma and hypermobility.

Through both study and lived experience, I've learned that real progress comes from understanding the body from multiple perspectives and learning how to work with it, not against it.

It's not about moving perfectly or following generic advice that ignores the reality of day-to-day fluctuations in pain, fatigue, stress or recovery.

The goal is not just to survive.

The goal is to build a body and life that allows you to thrive.

The Biggest Mistake

One of the biggest mistakes people make, especially when living with chronic conditions or recovering from injury, is trying to follow generic fitness advice that was never designed for their body, their life or their capacity.

That can look like:

- pushing through more on higher-energy days
- trying to stick rigidly to a plan
- comparing yourself to people with very different circumstances
- feeling like you've "failed" when symptoms flare or energy drops

Over time, this often creates a cycle of overdoing things, crashing, losing confidence and questioning whether your body can be trusted at all.

But the problem isn't that you're lazy, weak or unmotivated.

The problem is that most fitness advice doesn't leave room for adaptation.

Your training shouldn't expect it to be.

Let me be clear: You are not the problem. The programme is.

Training With Your Body

One of the most important parts of rebuilding strength is learning how to work with your body, rather than constantly fighting it.

Our capacity is not fixed. It changes in response to factors such as pain, fatigue, stress, illness, sleep, recovery and daily life demands.

That doesn't mean your body is failing — it means your body is responding to what is happening around and within it.

Some days you may have the energy and capacity for a full training session. Other days, your body may need a different approach.

Higher capacity days might look like:

- longer sessions
- higher intensity exercise

Lower capacity days might involve:

- breathing exercises
- rest and recovery

In between days might be:

- reduced volume or intensity
- focusing on movement quality

**Adapting your training is not “giving up” or “being lazy”.
Adaptation is a skill.**

Principles for Rebuilding

Start with what feels sustainable

Doing something repeatedly will always take you further than trying to do everything at once.

Progress is rarely linear

Symptoms fluctuate. Life changes. Setbacks happen. None of that erases your progress.

Adaptation is not failure

Adjusting your training to meet your current capacity is part of long-term strength building.

Rebuilding trust matters

Confidence in your body is just as important as physical strength or fitness and both take time to develop.

Life is not a transformation challenge

Health, movement and strength are lifelong journeys, not short-term projects.

Rest and recovery are not the same thing

A day without exercise doesn't automatically mean your body or mind has had a chance to recover.

Adapting Without Stopping

Responding to your body doesn't necessarily mean do everything or do nothing. There are ways to scale your training to work with what you have on the day, whilst contributing to your larger goals.

Example alternatives

Focus	Higher Capacity	Lower Capacity
Strength	60 min full-body session	20 min upper body session
Cardio	Running intervals	Walk or steady-state swim
Mobility	Structured reps & sets	Gentle movement flow
Recovery	Full training week	Extra sleep, mobility & pacing

Different does not mean less valuable.
The goal is not to train the same way every day.
The goal is to keep supporting your body over time.

Reflection

Take a moment to consider:

- What does “thriving” look like for you?
- What activities or experiences matter most to you?
- What would change if you trusted your body more?
- Where might adaptation help you stay more consistent instead of stopping completely?
- What is one thing you could do this week that feels supportive rather than overwhelming?

Small, sustainable steps still move you forward.

What Now?

You do not need to choose between respecting your body and building strength.

With the right support, it's possible to:

- adapt without giving up
- build confidence alongside strength
- train in a way that works with your life and your body
- continue pursuing the things that matter to you

If you'd like further support, I offer:

- yoga and fitness classes
- strength & movement coaching
- accountability & guidance

www.shrutiturner.co.uk

Find me on Social Media: @ShrutiTurner



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